
Topic 5: Clinical psychology

Topic overview

Students must show understanding that clinical psychology is about explaining and treating mental health issues, and of the different ways of treating them, including counselling and drug treatments.

Individual differences and developmental psychology must be considered when learning about links between personality factors and mental disorders and genetic influences (nature) or environmental influences (nurture) within different explanations for mental health disorders.

Subject content	What students need to learn:
5.1 Content	5.1.1 Diagnosis of mental disorders, including deviance, dysfunction, distress, and danger.
	5.1.2 Classification systems (DSM IVR or DSM V, and ICD) for mental health, including reliability and validity of diagnoses.
	5.1.3 Schizophrenia and one other disorder from anorexia nervosa, Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD) and unipolar depression. For schizophrenia • Description of symptoms and features, including thought insertion, hallucinations, delusions, disordered thinking. • The function of neurotransmitters as a theory/explanation. • One other biological theory/explanation. • One non-biological theory/explanation. For the other disorder • Description of symptoms and features. • Two explanations/theories: one biological theory/explanation and one non-biological theory/explanation.
	5.1.4 For schizophrenia and the other disorder, students should be familiar with two treatments for each disorder: one from biological and one from psychological. Two treatments for each disorder. The two for schizophrenia must come from different topic areas. The two for the other chosen disorder must come from different topic areas (these may be from the same topic areas as those used for schizophrenia).

Subject content	What students need to learn:
5.1 Content <i>(continued)</i>	5.1.5 Individual differences • Cultural effects can lead to individual differences in mental health disorders, e.g. non-biological explanation for schizophrenia. • Cultural effects can lead to different diagnoses of mental health disorders affecting reliability and validity. 5.1.6 Developmental psychology • Issues around genes and mental health, such as a genetic or biochemical explanation for schizophrenia, can affect development.